

Dear OTI Hiring Team,

I'm thrilled to be considered for the Senior Product Designer role at OTI. My time at the Office of Technology and Innovation (OTI) was one of the most rewarding periods of my career because it gave me the opportunity to work on products and services that directly impacted the lives of New Yorkers. It was also where my passion for accessibility and inclusive design truly took shape, working alongside talented colleagues who were committed to making city services more usable for everyone.

I left OTI to pursue a leadership opportunity at Reingold, where I served as UX Director, managing and mentoring designers while leading research and design efforts for government and mission-driven organizations. During that time, I led the UX strategy and information architecture redesign for Phoenix.gov, serving more than 1.5 million residents, led UX research initiatives for clients including St. Jude Global, Maximus, and the NFL Player Community, helped pilot a design system for the State of Nebraska focused on reusable patterns and components for government services, and conducted usability testing and research with participants through the Legal Aid Disaster Resource Center. Those experiences strengthened my ability to lead teams, navigate complex stakeholder environments, and deliver accessible, user-centered solutions at scale while deepening my appreciation for the role design systems and cross-functional collaboration play in creating consistent, sustainable public services.

What excites me most about this role is that it brings together the work I care about most: public service, user research, accessibility, design systems, and digital products that improve people's everyday lives. During my time at OTI, I worked on a wide range of products and services, including NYC311, Notify NYC, Materials for the Arts, the Department of Records' Order Vital Records service, NYC HOPE, and NYC Poletop Manager. Those experiences gave me a firsthand understanding of both the opportunities and challenges of designing digital services within city government.

I would welcome the opportunity to bring the leadership, research, and design experience I've gained since leaving OTI back to an organization whose mission I deeply respect. The chance to help shape the next generation of digital services for New Yorkers is exactly the kind of work that inspires me, and I would be honored to contribute to OTI once again.

Sincerely,



Carl Avidano